

Mayor / Vice-Mayor — Advance Questions (for their preparation)

English reference copy of

`mitsue_mayor_meeting_prep_questions_jp.md` (the version actually sent)

Register mirrors the Local Forestry Partner prep sheet: courteous, "no firm answers needed — a general sense of direction is enough." Tactics from the confidential talking-points script are deliberately excluded.

Thank you very much for making time to meet with us.

Earlier, we shared with the Vice Mayor a modest concept regarding the use of the former Sugano Elementary School (Mitsue Taiken Koryukan). Since then, through conversations with the local forestry group, the concept has broadened from that single building into something more integrated — **connecting three elements: forest, energy, and the data center**. At the meeting we would like to report that fuller picture and hear the Mayor's and Vice Mayor's thoughts.

To make the most of our time, we've listed the topics we'd like to raise. There's no need to prepare firm answers — a general sense of direction is enough. The project is currently at a feasibility stage (Phase 0); this is not a request for any commitment.

1. The former Sugano Elementary School (Koryukan)

- Our own rough analysis suggests the Koryukan may currently be running at a cost to the village. We'd be glad to bring the calculation if you'd like to see it.
- As one idea, we'd like to discuss whether making better use of just **one room** — a single classroom out of the many, with the rest left for the village's existing uses — could improve its finances.
- Relatedly, we understand the ECC (グローバル人材育成塾) received an exception to the 9:00–17:00 rule via a village ordinance. We'd like to learn how that exception was granted, and whether a similar route could apply to other uses.
- And if there has been any movement or new direction at the village level on the facility's use, we'd be grateful to hear it where appropriate.

2. Forest & forestry

- Are there any recent village-level discussions about cedar plantations or forest management?
- We envisage reforestation that gradually returns neglected sugi to **native broadleaf** over a long horizon — as a **distinct, additional planting effort** separate from the thinning the village already funds (施業放置林整備事業), carried out by 地域林業パートナー. Would the village have interest in that direction?
- The Mayor himself has named the **forestry-worker shortage** as a challenge in council (Dec 2020; June 2026). As a concrete response, we'd like to explore — in cooperation with the forestry cooperative (地域林業パートナー) — presenting the project to three recruit channels: ①Nara Forester Academy, ②林業就業支援講習, ③森林の仕事ガイダンス. Would the village be willing to back, or join us in, that outreach?
- We also noticed the village's own 地域おこし協力隊 (林業) **recruitment** (posted 2026-04-24; sangyo_koyo/2542), which lists **"development of new wood-use methods, including woody biomass"** (木質バイオマス等、新たな木材利用方法の開発) among the duties — but leaves the end-use open. Our mitsue.it

concept — using thinnings for biomass CHP to supply heat and power, including to an AI data center — is one concrete answer to exactly that line. **Could the project, together with the cooperative, serve as the vehicle to develop that biomass use, rather than the village carrying it alone?**

3. Energy & EV charging

- We've read the village's 2025 "Plan for Maximum Introduction of Renewable Energy." We believe our concept (biomass CHP, solar, data center) could be one way to carry out and operate that plan — we'd welcome your thoughts.
- Who currently manages the village's EV chargers (the clinic 200V unit, the roadside-station fast charger, etc.)?
- Regarding the Regional Decarbonization Transition & RE Promotion Grant (地域脱炭素移行・再エネ推進交付金), is there room for us to serve as an operating partner?

4. Disaster resilience

- Which facilities are currently designated as evacuation shelters?
- Is there any thought of using a facility like Himeishi-no-Yu (Mitsue Onsen) as a base during power outages or disasters (防災拠点)?

5. AI use in the village office

- As part of the data-center concept, we are exploring a **local AI service** that could run on village-generated power, with data never leaving the village. To judge whether it would be useful, may we ask: does the village office currently use any AI tools (for drafting, translation, summarizing documents, etc.)?
- If so, roughly what does the village pay for them (subscriptions or per-use fees)? And are there any concerns about where the entered data is sent?
- No exact figures are needed — a general sense is enough. It simply helps us judge whether a locally-run, no-per-use-fee option would be worth designing.

6. How to proceed

- We'd welcome your current thinking on whether the village might take a more active role in this concept.
- We'd also like to discuss alignment with the village's "5 new enterprises in 5 years" policy.
- And your guidance on whether future discussions should continue through the Vice Mayor, or directly with the Mayor.

The goal for the day is not to reach conclusions, but to hear your thinking and concerns and find a good way forward together. Please let us know if anything is unclear in advance.

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